

10.3 Memory - SD / MMC / XD / CompactFlash

Memory is absolutely essential for cameras and it's even more so today with the resolution of cameras significantly increasing. 10 MP point-and-shoot cameras are standard today. The file size of a typical photo from one of these cameras can be well over 3 to 4 MB. Memory cards are now cheaper and capacities have gone up a lot. 2 GB is sufficient for most users and 4 GB is recommended.

dSLRs also store JPEGs, but they are better known for capturing RAW files. RAW files are uncompressed, store better quality, and therefore, much larger than JPEG files. Some dSLRs use CompactFlash (CF) cards to store data. These are less compact than the SD/MMC and xD cards.

Unfortunately, not all brands use and accept the same standard of memory in their cameras. However, the most commonly used memory is Secure Digital (SD). Secure Digital High Capacity (SDHC) is similar to SD, but the maximum capacity goes upto 32 GB.

xD-Picture cards are usually found on Olympus cameras. Sony has its own proprietary standard. These can be a little more expensive than SD. One should make it a habit to carry more than one memory card for storing and carrying.



SD-MMC-XD-Compact Flash - SD Memory



SD-MMC-XD-Compact Flash - SDHC Card



SD-MMC-XD-Compact Flash - Compact Flash



SD-MMC-XD-Compact Flash - XD card



SD-MMC-XD-Compact Flash - Memory Stick